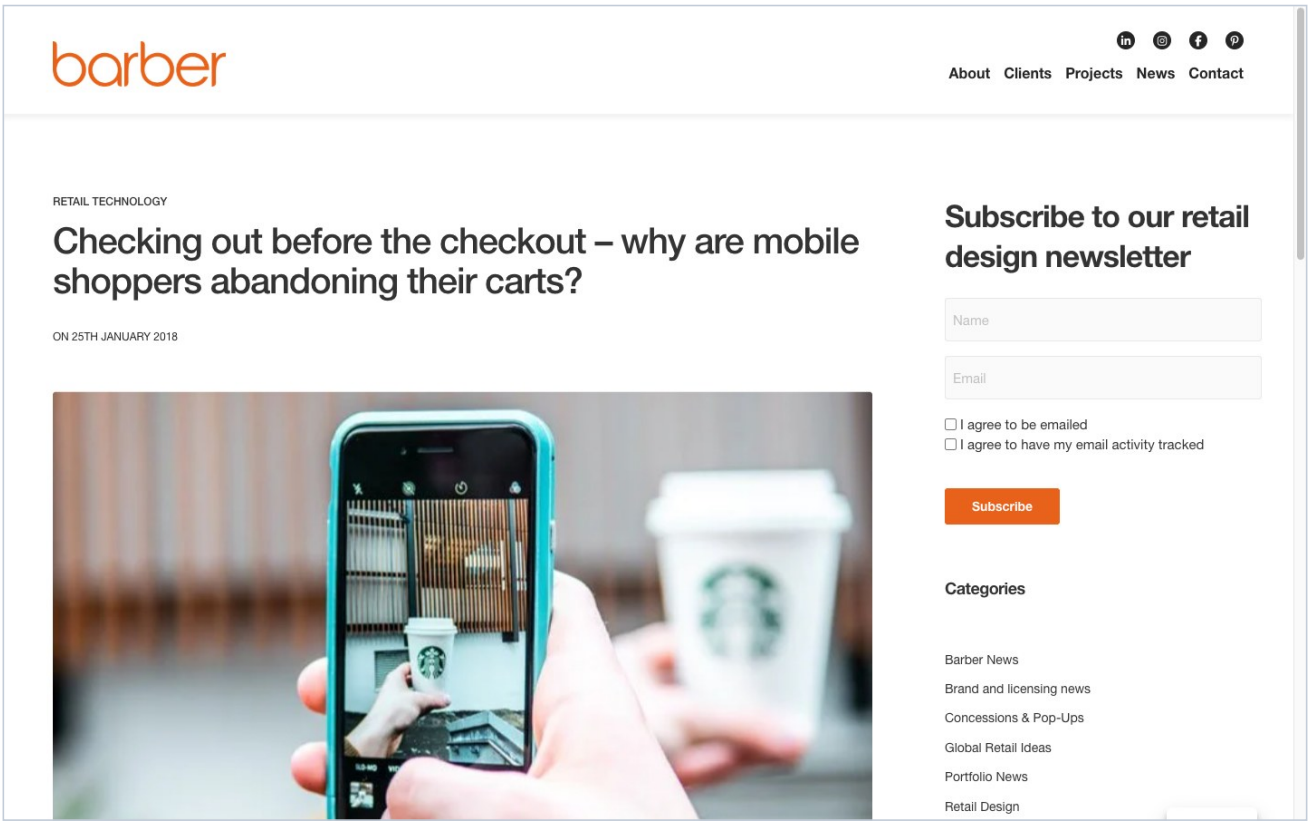
Barber Design

«Checking out before the checkout – why are mobile shoppers abandoning their carts?»

25 January 2018 · English · Named and quoted.

https://barberdesign.co.uk/blog/why-are-mobile-shoppers-abandoning-their-carts/

Research. Huang, G.H., Korfiatis, N. and Chang, C.T. (2018). Mobile Shopping Cart Abandonment: The roles of Conflicts, Ambivalence, and Hesitation. *Journal of Business Research*, 85, 165-174.



According to figures, mobile apps are quickly becoming one of the most popular ways to shop online, but in spite of this the 'abandoned cart' phenomenon is much higher amongst mobile users than desktop-based online shoppers. Market research firm Criteo report that the amount of ecommerce traffic from mobile devices steadily increased to 46% of global ecommerce traffic – but only 27% of mobile purchases were actually completed – and the conversion rates for mobile shoppers were much lower than those made on laptop or PC.

Overcoming the challenges for mobile shoppers

Dr Nikolaos Korfiatis of the Norwich Business School at the University of East Anglia has been investigating the 'abandoned cart' phenomenon and suggests that it presents a big challenge for online retailers in 2018. Because the web is geared towards 'mobile first' retailers have been investing heavily in mobile shopping apps and responsive websites but they are not yet feeling the benefits from sales conversion – as potential customers frequently quit before checking out:

"Our study results revealed a paradox: mobile shopping is supposed to make the process easier – and yet concerns about making the right choice, or about whether the site is secure enough lead to an emotional ambivalence about the transaction and that means customers are much more likely to simply abandon their shopping carts without completing a purchase."

The data used in the study came from online shopping data from 2016-2017 from consumers in Taiwan and the US. The research team investigating the phenomenon identified the key reasons for hesitation at the checkout stage were generally the same in both settings. They also found that shoppers were far more likely to use mobile apps to research products in their spare time as they prepare for a purchase, which may also go some way to explaining why they don't always go through with the deal.

One factor that isn't discussed in the findings is the very nature of the device. It is used on the go – and it is a constant source of interruption. This may also have a significant impact on conversion rates. Whilst attempting to shop or research products on the move, a mobile user is more likely to be interrupted during the process by various unpredictable environmental factors, along with interruptions from texts and calls – or loss of signal.

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